

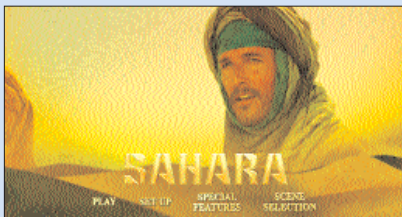
check whether your video is really streaming, open another instance of VLC. Click on the File menu, select "Open Network Stream", select the "HTTP/HTTPS/.." radio button on the Network tab, and enter "localhost:8080" in the URL dialog box. Click OK.

If all is well, you should now be able to see the video you're broadcasting, in this new instance of VLC. If you pause the video in the server, the video will pause playing in the second VLC instance. To access the video on another computer in the network, just replace "localhost" with the IP address of the server PC.

You can even adapt this to stream live video such as from a TV-Tuner or a webcam across the network. To do this, open the Wizard, and with the "Stream to Network" radio button checked, click Next. Then click Choose. Click on the DirectShow tab and choose the device to use for video and audio capture using the "Video device name" and "Audio device name" selectors. Click on the Configure button to access the settings of your selected device.

Playing A DVD

VLC is fully capable of playing DVDs as well; it even lets you easily navigate a DVD using its menu structure. Go to File > Open Disc or press [Ctrl]+[D]. In the window that opens, select the

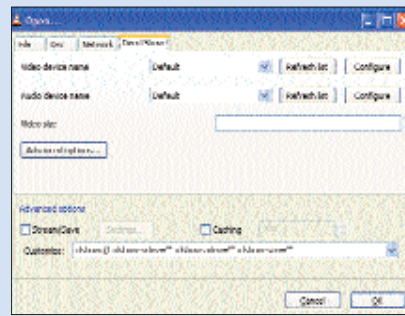


You can play DVDs using VLC

DVD (menus) radio button and enter the DVD drive letter followed by a colon, such as "I:" as the Device Name. Alternatively, you can enter the MRL (Media Resource Locator) as "dvd://E:" in the Customize dialog box (assuming E is your DVD drive letter). Click OK. You can choose the Audio format, Subtitle, Language, etc. by clicking on the appropriate menus.

Working With Capture Devices

You can even play and stream the content from a capture device, be it a webcam, video capture card, or a TV-Tuner, using VLC. The only prerequisite is that you need to install the WDM drivers for the capture device. Click on File > Open Capture Device or simply press [Ctrl] + [A]. Choose the device to

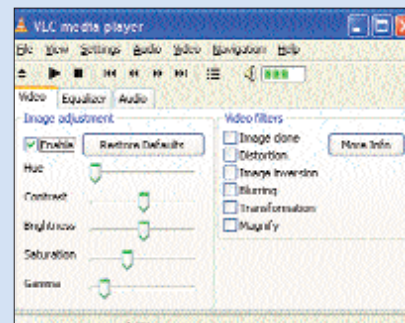


Displaying video from capture devices

use for video and audio capture using the "Video device name" and "Audio device name" selectors. You can access the settings of your selected device through the Configure button.

The Extended GUI

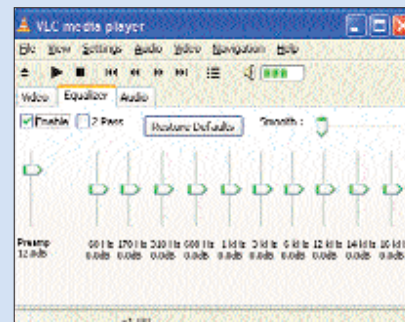
Go to Settings > Extended GUI for the Extended GUI, which gives you access to a load of settings that let you tweak your video. Under the Video tab, check the box next to Enable, and you will be able to adjust the Hue, Contrast, Brightness, Saturation, and Gamma to suit your viewing needs. VLC also features additional video effects such as



Adjusting image quality

Image Clone, Distortion, Image inversion and Blurring, Transformation, and Magnify.

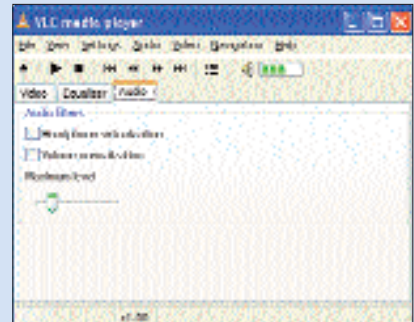
Like any other media player, VLC, too, has a 10-band graphic equaliser. Click on the Equalizer tab to access it. Check the box next to "2 Pass" to apply the equaliser twice for sharper



The 10-band graphic equaliser

effects. Moving the Smooth slider to the right will control the blending of the equalizer bands. The more towards the right it is, the more correlated the movements of adjoining equalisers will be. The equaliser has preset modes as well, but to access them, you need to enter the Preferences section in VLC.

VLC features two audio filters—a volume normaliser and Headphone

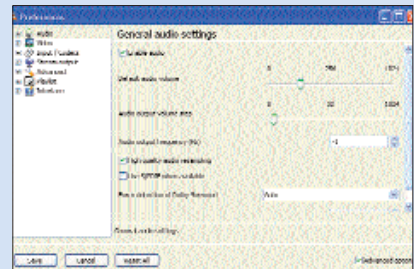


More audio tuning

virtualisation. The Volume Normaliser is nothing but a limiter that caps the maximum volume of the player. Headphone virtualisation is a filter that provides sound spatialisation when using headphones. Spatialisation of sound is an enhanced reproduction of sound that mimics multiple speakers even when only two speakers (in this case, headphones) are being used, thereby adding the immersive touch.

Additional Preferences

You can further tweak the various settings of VLC by entering the Preferences. Go to Settings > Preferences; here, you can adjust var-



Adjusting the Preferences

ious audio settings such as Filters, Output modules, and even Visualisations.

There's a whole lot more to explore, and you should now be in a position to experiment with the player on your own. VLC media player is certainly the jack of all codecs and the master of most! ■

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